

SLOW TO ANGER

A Scripture-Based Workbook for
Managing Anger God's Way

James 1:19 - Be quick to listen, slow to speak, slow to anger

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WHAT THE BIBLE SAYS ABOUT ANGER

Anger itself is NOT always sin. Even God gets angry (at injustice).

RIGHTEOUS ANGER (acceptable):

- Jesus overturning tables (John 2:15) - anger at exploitation
- God's anger at oppression (Exodus 3:7-9)
- Anger at injustice, abuse, evil

SINFUL ANGER (what we need to manage):

- Anger that leads to harm (Cain - Genesis 4:5-8)
- Anger held too long (Ephesians 4:26 - don't let sun go down)
- Anger that destroys relationships
- Anger rooted in pride, selfishness, or control

KEY SCRIPTURES:

James 1:19-20 - Be slow to anger; human anger does not produce the righteousness that God desires.

Proverbs 15:1 - A gentle answer turns away wrath.

Ephesians 4:26 - Be angry and do not sin.

JAMES 1:19-20 DEEP DIVE

'My dear brothers and sisters, take note of this:

Everyone should be quick to listen, slow to speak

and slow to become angry, because human anger does not produce the righteousness that God desires.'

QUICK TO LISTEN

Before reacting, truly hear the other person.

Am I listening to understand or to respond?

SLOW TO SPEAK

Pause before words leave your mouth.

What am I about to say? Is it helpful or hurtful?

SLOW TO ANGER

Create space between trigger and response.

Can I wait 10 seconds before reacting?

MY ANGER TRIGGERS

Identify what sets you off. Check all that apply:

- ☐ Being disrespected
- ☐ Feeling controlled
- ☐ Injustice/unfairness
- ☐ Being interrupted
- ☐ Feeling ignored
- ☐ Traffic/delays
- ☐ Messy house
- ☐ Money stress
- ☐ Being lied to
- ☐ Feeling overwhelmed
- ☐ Parenting challenges
- ☐ Work pressure

My TOP 3 triggers:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

MY BODY'S WARNING SIGNS

Anger shows up in your body before your words. Notice:

- ☐ Jaw clenching
- ☐ Fists tightening
- ☐ Heart racing
- ☐ Face getting hot
- ☐ Chest tightening
- ☐ Rapid breathing
- ☐ Muscle tension (shoulders/neck)
- ☐ Stomach churning

When I notice these signs, I can:

1. STOP - Don't react yet
2. BREATHE - 4 deep breaths
3. PRAY - 'Lord, help me respond not react'
4. CHOOSE - What does love look like here?

THE ANGER CYCLE

Trigger -> Thought -> Feeling -> Response

Example:

Trigger: Spouse criticizes my cooking

Thought: 'Nothing I do is ever good enough!'

Feeling: Anger (8/10), hurt (7/10)

Response: Yell back, slam door

MY ANGER CYCLE:

Trigger:

Thought:

Feeling:

Response:

Better response with God's help:

RESTRUCTURING WITH PROVERBS 15:1

"A gentle answer turns away wrath, but a harsh word stirs up anger."

Application:

When I want to respond harshly, I can choose gentle words instead.

WORKSHEET:

Angry thought I had recently:

What Proverbs says about this:

A wiser response would be:

How I felt after choosing wisdom:

RESTRUCTURING WITH PROVERBS 14:29

"Whoever is slow to anger has great understanding."

Application:

Pausing before reacting shows wisdom, not weakness.

WORKSHEET:

Angry thought I had recently:

What Proverbs says about this:

A wiser response would be:

How I felt after choosing wisdom:

RESTRUCTURING WITH PROVERBS 19:11

"Good sense makes one slow to anger, and it is his glory to overlook an offense."

Application:

Not every offense deserves a response. I can choose to let go.

WORKSHEET:

Angry thought I had recently:

What Proverbs says about this:

A wiser response would be:

How I felt after choosing wisdom:

RESTRUCTURING WITH PROVERBS 29:11

"A fool gives full vent to his spirit, but a wise man quietly holds it back."

Application:

Controlling my anger is strength, not suppression.

WORKSHEET:

Angry thought I had recently:

What Proverbs says about this:

A wiser response would be:

How I felt after choosing wisdom:

RESTRUCTURING WITH PROVERBS 16:32

"Whoever is slow to anger is better than the mighty."

Application:

Self-control is more powerful than physical strength.

WORKSHEET:

Angry thought I had recently:

What Proverbs says about this:

A wiser response would be:

How I felt after choosing wisdom:

RESTRUCTURING WITH PROVERBS 22:24-25

"Make no friendship with a man given to anger."

Application:

My anger affects others. I choose to be safe for people I love.

WORKSHEET:

Angry thought I had recently:

What Proverbs says about this:

A wiser response would be:

How I felt after choosing wisdom:

SPEAKING TRUTH IN LOVE

Ephesians 4:15

Instead of attacking, try this formula:

'When [situation], I feel [emotion] because [reason].
I need [request]. Can we work on this together?'

Example:

Instead of: 'You NEVER help around the house!'

Try: 'When dishes pile up, I feel overwhelmed because
I need support. Can we divide chores together?'

MY PRACTICE:

Situation 1:

My old response:

My new response:

Situation 2:

My old response:

My new response:

Situation 3:

My old response:

My new response:

CONFLICT RESOLUTION - THE MATTHEW 18 MODEL

Step 1: Go Directly (v.15)

Talk to the person privately first. Not to others.

Step 2: Bring a Witness (v.16)

If unresolved, bring a trusted mediator.

Step 3: Involve Leadership (v.17)

If still unresolved, seek pastoral counsel.

Step 4: Set Boundaries

Protect yourself while pursuing reconciliation.

FORGIVENESS

Not condoning, but releasing

Forgiveness IS:

- Releasing the debt someone owes you
- Choosing not to seek revenge
- Trusting God with justice
- Freedom for YOUR heart

Forgiveness is NOT:

- Saying what happened was okay
- Trusting the person again immediately
- Forgetting (you may always remember)
- Staying in an abusive situation

Colossians 3:13 - Forgive as the Lord forgave you.

Who do I need to forgive?

ANGER + PRAYER LOG - WEEK 1

Day	Anger(1-10)	Trigger	Response	Prayer?
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

Progress I noticed:

ANGER + PRAYER LOG - WEEK 2

Day	Anger(1-10)	Trigger	Response	Prayer?
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

Progress I noticed:

ANGER + PRAYER LOG - WEEK 3

Day	Anger(1-10)	Trigger	Response	Prayer?
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

Progress I noticed:

ANGER + PRAYER LOG - WEEK 4

Day	Anger(1-10)	Trigger	Response	Prayer?
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

Progress I noticed:

ANGER + PRAYER LOG - WEEK 5

Day	Anger(1-10)	Trigger	Response	Prayer?
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

Progress I noticed:

ACCOUNTABILITY PARTNER AGREEMENT

I, _____, commit to:

1. Being honest about my anger struggles
2. Meeting regularly with my partner for check-ins
3. Calling my partner BEFORE I react in anger
4. Being open to feedback without defensiveness
5. Praying for my partner as they pray for me

My accountability partner: _____

We will meet: (day/time) _____

Our check-in questions:

- Did you lose your temper this week?
- What triggered you?
- How did you respond?
- What would you do differently?
- How can I pray for you?

Signed: _____ Date: _____

MY COMMITMENT TO CHANGE

With God's help and the power of the Holy Spirit, I commit to:

- ☐ Being slow to anger (James 1:19)
- ☐ Using gentle words (Proverbs 15:1)
- ☐ Forgiving others as God forgave me (Colossians 3:13)
- ☐ Not going to bed angry (Ephesians 4:26)
- ☐ Seeking help when I need it (Proverbs 12:15)

Signed: _____

Date: _____

'He who is slow to anger is better than the mighty.' - Proverbs 16:32